

The Review Engine **for Roofers**

The system for getting a Google review from every happy customer: the crew line, the scripts, the reply templates, and what gets a profile wiped. Free.

The Review Engine for Roofers

You are one roofer with a smaller review count than the company four miles away, and that number is deciding which of you the homeowner calls.

This fixes that. It is a system for asking every customer, once, at the right moment — run by your crew, not by you — and it takes about twenty minutes to set up.

It is not software and there is nothing to subscribe to. It is the process, the words, and the printable cards.

What is in here

File	What it is
01-THE-SYSTEM.md	The playbook. Read this one first — about ten minutes.
02-SCRIPTS.md	Every script: the crew's fifteen-second line, the follow-up text, email, invoice line.
03-REPLIES.md	Reply templates for five-star down to one-star, plus fake reviews.
04-WHAT-GETS-YOU-WIPED.md	One page on what actually violates Google's rules. Read it before you build anything.
05-tracker.csv	The tracker. Opens in Excel, Numbers or Google Sheets.
06-print-cards.html	Makes your leave-behind cards, four to a sheet. Open it in any browser.
06-PRINT-CARDS-README.md	How to use that page.

If you only have twenty minutes today

1. Open your Google Business Profile and press **"Ask for reviews"**. Copy the link, save the QR code. *(Two minutes.)*
2. Open **06-print-cards.html**, fill in your company name and phone, add the QR code, print a sheet, cut it up, put the stack in the truck. *(Ten minutes.)*
3. Read the crew line at the top of **02-SCRIPTS.md** and send it to your crew chiefs. *(Three minutes.)*
4. Open **05-tracker.csv**, delete the example rows, keep the headers. *(One minute.)*

That is the engine running. Everything else sharpens it.

The one thing to get right

Ninety percent of the failures with this are not the script and not the timing. They are that **the card never left the truck**.

If your numbers are not moving in a month, do not rewrite the text message. Go and count how many cards are left in the stack. That one question will tell you what is wrong.

A word on the rules

Google removed a lot of review activity in 2026 and tightened the rules on incentives and on-site review stations. Several things widely sold as best practice in this industry — gating out unhappy customers, offering a discount for a review, handing over a tablet on site — can cost you every review you have ever collected, not just the new ones.

Nothing in this system does any of that. **The same link goes to every customer, with nothing attached to it.** That is not just the safe way, it is the way that produces a profile homeowners actually believe.

This kit is for one company's own use. Please don't resell or redistribute it.

The Review Engine for Roofers

The whole system, in one line: ask every customer once, at the moment they are standing in the driveway looking at their new roof, with a link that takes one tap.

That is it. Everything else in this file is detail about how to make that happen when you are not the one on the roof.

Why roofing is different, and why generic review advice fails you

Most review advice is written for restaurants and salons — businesses that see the same customer forty times a year and can ask again next visit. You do not get a next visit. A roof lasts twenty-five years. **You get one chance per customer, and if you miss it, that review is gone forever.**

Three things follow from that, and they shape the entire system:

- 1. The moment matters more than the message.** A restaurant can send a mediocre text next Tuesday. You have a window that opens when the homeowner sees the finished roof and closes about seventy-two hours later, when the job stops being the most interesting thing that happened to them that week. Miss it and no amount of clever copy recovers it.
 - 2. You are almost never the one standing there.** Your crew chief is. That means the system has to work when handed to someone who does not care about your Google ranking and will not remember a four-step process. If your review system requires you personally to be on site, you do not have a system, you have an intention.
 - 3. Half your jobs are insurance jobs, and those have a different clock.** A homeowner mid-claim is stressed and does not know yet whether you are the hero or another problem. Asking then gets you silence at best. The window on an insurance job opens **after the claim settles and the supplement is paid** — sometimes weeks after the roof is finished.
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The count that actually matters

Before you build anything, go look at what your competition has. Search your trade and your town — *roofer in [your town]* — and write down the review count of the three companies that show up in the map pack above you.

You are not trying to beat the regional outfit with 4,000 reviews. That company has ninety crews and a marketing department and you will not catch them this year. **You are trying to beat the roofer four miles away who has 61 reviews while you have 14.** That is the gap that decides which of you the homeowner calls, and it is a gap you can close in a season.

Write both numbers down. Yours, and theirs. That is your target, and you will check it again in ninety days.

What Google actually allows — read this before you build anything

This is the part almost every review guide gets wrong, and getting it wrong can wipe every review you have ever collected. All of it is straight from Google's own published policy.

Allowed, and Google's own recommended method: asking customers to visit a review link or scan a QR code, and sharing that link on a printed card, a follow-up email, an invoice, or a thank-you message.

Prohibited — "Incentivized or Biased Reviews." In Google's words, incentivized reviews are *"reviews and ratings influenced by a payment, discount, free goods or services, or any other benefit offered to the reviewer."* So no gift cards, no discount for a review, no draw entry, no "\$50 off your next repair if you leave us five stars." Google classes this as fake and misleading content.

Prohibited — review gating. Gating is asking customers how they feel first, then only sending the review link to the happy ones. It is extremely common in the trades, several software products still sell it as a feature, and it is against policy. It also does not work as well as people think: Google's own guidance is that *"a mix of positive and negative feedback often feels more trustworthy."* A profile with nothing but flawless five-stars reads as fake to homeowners.

The rule this product runs on: the same link goes to every single customer, no screening. If that makes you nervous, that nervousness is information about the job, not about the system.

One more: the customer must be signed in to a Google account to leave a review. They can create one with any email address, not just Gmail. This is the single most common reason an enthusiastic customer never actually posts.

Setup — about twenty minutes, once

Step 1 — get your official review link and QR code. Open your Google Business Profile and use "Ask for reviews". Google generates both the link and a QR code for you. Use Google's own — not a third-party generator. It is free, it always points to the right place, and it cannot break when

someone else's service shuts down. Save the link somewhere you can paste it from your phone in two seconds: a note pinned to your home screen, or a text shortcut.

Step 2 — make the link one tap. Set up a text-replacement shortcut on the crew phones so typing something like `revlink` expands to the full URL. On iPhone that is Settings → General → Keyboard → Text Replacement. If the crew has to hunt for the link, they will not send it.

Step 3 — print the cards. Open `06-print-cards.html` in any browser, drop in your QR code, and print. Four cards per sheet, cut them, and put a stack in every truck. See `06-PRINT-CARDS-README.md`.

Step 4 — brief the crew. One sentence: *"When the homeowner comes out to look at the finished roof and says something nice, hand them a card and say the line."* The line is in `02-SCRIPTS.md` and it is fifteen seconds long. Do not give your crew a process. Give them one sentence and one card.

Step 5 — set up the follow-up. One text, three days later, from the office. Not from the crew. Template is in `02-SCRIPTS.md`.

The run cycle

On the job — the crew's part. Final walkthrough, homeowner is looking at the roof. Hand the card, say the line, leave. That is the entire crew responsibility. No app, no tablet, no QR stand — Google has moved against on-site review kiosks and shared tablets, so keep it to a card the homeowner takes away and scans on their own phone, later, in their own time.

That evening — the office's part. Log the job in `05-tracker.csv`: name, address, crew chief, date, whether the card was handed over. Thirty seconds a job.

Three days later — the one follow-up. Send the text. One. Then stop.

This is where almost everyone gets it wrong in both directions. Asking once and never following up leaves most of your reviews uncollected, because people meant to and forgot. Asking four times makes you the roofer who nags, and the fourth text is how you turn a happy customer into a one-star. **One ask in person, one follow-up text, then let it go.**

Within twenty-four hours of any review arriving — reply. Every time, good or bad. Templates in `03-REPLIES.md`. This is the highest-leverage ten minutes in the whole system and it is the step people skip, because replying feels optional. It is not: your replies are public, and the homeowner reading your profile six months from now is reading how you handled the bad one.

Insurance jobs — different clock. Do not ask during the claim. Tag the job in the tracker as insurance, and ask when the claim settles and the final payment clears. Send the ask by text at that

point rather than in person, since you will not be on site.

Every ninety days — check the number. Yours, and the roofer four miles away. That is the only metric in this system.

What to expect, honestly

Most roofers running this get a review from somewhere between a fifth and a third of the customers they actually ask. The variable is not the script — it is whether the ask happened at all. **The system fails at the crew step, not the copy step, essentially every time.**

So if the numbers are not moving, do not rewrite the text message. Go and find out how many cards left the truck. That single question explains nearly every underperforming review system in the trades.

At twenty jobs a month with a fifth of asked customers responding, you are adding roughly four reviews a month. That is 48 a year, which for most roofers is the difference between being invisible and being the obvious choice in their town. **It compounds and it does not stop, which is exactly why it is worth building once and running forever.**

When to stop doing this yourself

You should run this manually for at least ninety days. You will learn what your customers actually say, which crews hand out cards and which do not, and what your real response rate is. That knowledge is worth more than any automation.

The moment it makes sense to automate is when the follow-up text stops going out reliably because everyone is busy — usually somewhere north of forty jobs a month. At that point the tracker becomes the bottleneck and you want the ask triggered automatically off your job management system.

That is a real service and it costs real money, and you should not buy it until the manual version has proven the ask is happening on site. **Automating a review system whose crews are not handing out cards just automates the silence.**

Scripts

Copy these, change the bracketed parts, use them. They are deliberately plain — the ones that sound like marketing get ignored.

Two rules that apply to every script here:

- **Never mention the star rating you want.** Not "a five-star review", not "if we earned five stars". Ask for a review, not a rating. Asking for a specific rating is the line between asking and biasing, and biased reviews are a policy violation.
- **Never attach anything to it.** No discount, no draw, no free gutter clean, no "we'll knock \$50 off". Google's policy names payment, discount, free goods or services and *"any other benefit"* as incentivized reviews, which is prohibited content.

1. The crew line — in person, at the final walkthrough

This is the one that matters. Fifteen seconds. The crew chief says it while handing over the card, when the homeowner is looking at the finished roof.

"Glad you're happy with it. If you've got a minute this week, a quick review on Google genuinely helps us out — the card's got a code you can scan with your phone camera. No pressure either way, and thanks for having us out."

Why it is built this way:

- **"Glad you're happy with it"** only works if they just said something positive. If they did not, skip the ask entirely — the tracker has a column for that, and a job that ends flat is a job to follow up on, not to request a review from.
- **"a minute this week"** sets an honest, small time cost and does not demand it now.
- **"genuinely helps us out"** is the actual reason and homeowners respond to it. Small local businesses get real goodwill from this; do not dress it up.
- **"the card's got a code"** moves the work to the card, so the crew never has to spell out a URL or handle someone's phone.
- **"No pressure either way"** is the part people cut, and it is the part that makes it land. It also keeps you the right side of the line, because it makes the ask genuinely optional.

If the homeowner is not home at the walkthrough — very common — the crew leaves the card in the door or on the counter, and the ask moves to text. Log it either way.

2. The follow-up text — three days later, from the office

One text. Sent three days after the job, from the office phone, not the crew's.

Hi [First name] — [Your name] from [Company]. Hope the new roof's looking good after the weekend. If you've got a second, we'd really appreciate a quick Google review: [link] Thanks again for choosing us.

Notes:

- **Three days** is deliberate. Same-day competes with the relief of the job being over, and a week later they have moved on.
- **Reference the actual job** — "the new roof", "the ridge vent", "getting that leak sorted". A text that could have been sent to anyone reads like a mass text, because it is.
- **The link goes last**, on its own. Do not bury it mid-sentence.
- **This is the only follow-up**. There is no second text. If they do not respond, they do not respond, and you keep the goodwill of a customer who will still refer you.

Insurance-job variant, sent after the claim settles and final payment clears:

Hi [First name] — [Your name] at [Company]. Glad we got everything closed out with [insurer] and the roof squared away. That process is a lot to deal with, and if you've got a minute, a quick Google review would really help other homeowners going through the same thing: [link]

The claim experience is the thing they will actually want to talk about, and "helps other homeowners going through the same thing" is true and is the strongest motivator you have on storm work.

3. Email version — for commercial and property-manager jobs

Commercial contacts respond to email where homeowners respond to text.

Subject: Quick favour re: [property address]

Hi [Name],

Now that the work at [property address] is wrapped up, I wanted to say thanks for having us on it.

If you were happy with how it went, would you mind leaving us a short Google review? It makes a real difference for us when other property managers are deciding who to call.

[link]

Either way, appreciate the business — give me a shout directly if anything comes up with the roof.

[Your name] [Direct number]

4. On the invoice

One line at the bottom of every invoice and every final paperwork packet. It costs nothing and it catches the customers who were happy but were not home at the walkthrough.

Happy with the work? A quick Google review helps us more than you'd think: [link] *(or scan the code on the card we left)*

5. What to say when they say "sure, how?"

Roughly half the time the customer wants to and then never does, because they hit friction. The friction is almost always the same one, so answer it before it happens:

"Scan the code with your camera and it opens straight to the review box. Only thing is Google will ask you to be signed in — any email works for that, it doesn't have to be Gmail."

This one sentence recovers more reviews than any other change you can make. The sign-in wall is where willing customers quietly give up, and almost nobody warns them.

6. The one you should not send

Do not send this, or anything shaped like it:

~~"How did we do? Reply 1-5. If you'd rate us a 5, here's our Google link — if not, let us know how we can fix it."~~

That is review gating: screening for sentiment and only routing the happy ones to Google. It is against Google policy, plenty of tools still sell it as a feature, and the businesses that get caught can lose every review they have collected.

It is also worse on its own terms. Ask everyone, reply well to the occasional bad one, and you end up with a profile that homeowners believe. A wall of flawless five-stars reads as purchased, and Google's own guidance says a mix of feedback feels more trustworthy.

If you want to catch problems before they become public reviews, do it properly: have the crew chief ask *"anything you're not happy with?"* at the walkthrough, and fix it then. That is quality control, and it is completely legitimate. What you cannot do is use the answer to decide who gets the link.

Reply templates

Reply to every review within twenty-four hours. Google's own guidance is that replies should be short, personal, professional, and conversational rather than promotional — and that you should not use a reply to push offers or deals.

Who your replies are actually for: not the reviewer. The homeowner reading your profile six months from now, deciding whether to call you. That person will read your worst review and your reply to it, and decide based on the reply.

Rotate the wording. Ten identical "Thank you for your business!" replies look automated and Google explicitly advises against sending everyone the same thank-you.

Five-star, with detail

Thanks [First name] — really glad [specific thing they mentioned] worked out. [Crew chief's first name] and the guys will be happy to hear it. Give us a shout if anything comes up down the line.
— [Your name]

Naming the crew chief is the highest-value thing you can put in a reply. It reads as a real company with real people, and the crew see it.

Five-star, no text — just the rating

Thanks for the five stars, [First name] — appreciated. — [Your name]

Short is correct here. There is nothing to respond to, and padding it looks odd.

Four-star

Do not ask what went wrong. It reads as ungrateful for a good review.

Thanks [First name], appreciate you taking the time. Glad the roof's sorted — if there's anything

still outstanding, call me direct on [number] and I'll get it handled. — [Your name]

Three-star

Thanks for the honest feedback, [First name]. [Acknowledge the specific issue.] That's not the standard we aim for and I'd like to put it right — I'm on [number] if you'll give me the chance. — [Your name]

One and two-star — the one that matters

This is the reply future customers will read most closely. Four rules, all from Google's published guidance: never share the reviewer's private information, never make it personal, be honest about what was and was not in your control, and take it offline.

[First name], I'm sorry — [specific thing] shouldn't have happened and I understand why you're frustrated. [One sentence, plainly, on what went wrong or what you've changed.] I'd like to make it right. I'm on [number] and I'll pick up personally. — [Your name]

What to avoid, because each of these actively costs you future customers:

- **Arguing the facts.** Even when you are right. The reader is not adjudicating, they are judging your temperament.
- **"We have no record of you in our system."** The single worst reply in the trades. It reads as calling the customer a liar, and it is the standard opener for defensive contractors. If you genuinely think it is not your customer, see the fake-review section below — do not litigate it in public.
- **Explaining your cancellation policy at length.** Nobody reads paragraph three.
- **Offering a discount to remove it.** Paying for a review change is exactly what the incentivized-reviews policy prohibits.

Weather, supply and schedule complaints

Common in roofing and mostly not your fault, but "not our fault" is a bad reply. Google's guidance is to acknowledge what happened, be honest about limitations, and explain what you can and cannot control.

Thanks for the feedback [First name], and I'm sorry the schedule slipped. We won't tear off a roof with storms forecast — it does mean delays, and I know that's frustrating when you've booked time off. We could have kept you better updated and that part's on us. — [Your name]

Conceding the part that is genuinely yours — the communication — is what makes the rest credible.

Insurance-claim frustration

[First name], I hear you — claims are a slog and I'm sorry it dragged. We push the adjusters as hard as we're able but we don't control their timeline, which I know isn't much comfort when you're the one waiting. Glad the roof itself came out right. — [Your name]

Reviews you believe are fake or not your customer

It happens: a competitor, a mistaken-identity review meant for a similarly named company, or someone who never hired you.

1. **Flag it to Google first.** If a review violates Google's content policies you can report it — that is the documented route and it is the only one that can actually get it removed. Do this before you reply.
2. **Then reply once, calmly,** because removal is slow and uncertain and meanwhile people are reading it.

We've got no record of work at this address and we think this may have been meant for another company — happy to be corrected. If you have dealt with us and I've got this wrong, please call me on [number], I'd genuinely like to sort it. — [Your name]

That wording works because it states your position, leaves room to be wrong, and does not call anyone a liar. **Never accuse a competitor in public.** You cannot prove it, and it makes you look worse than the review did.

Do not buy reviews to bury a bad one. Beyond being prohibited, purchased reviews arrive in a recognisable burst and put your whole profile at risk — including the genuine reviews you worked for.

What gets your reviews wiped

One page. Read it once, then keep it where whoever handles your marketing can see it.

Every item here is from Google's published policy, not from opinion. The reason it matters is that enforcement is not surgical: Google can remove a batch of reviews or restrict a profile, and the genuine reviews you spent two years earning go with the bad ones.

The seven

- 1. Offering anything in exchange for a review.** Google defines incentivized reviews as those *"influenced by a payment, discount, free goods or services, or any other benefit offered to the reviewer."* That covers gift cards, discounts, entries into a draw, a free gutter clean, and "we'll take \$50 off". It is classed as fake and misleading content.
 - 2. Review gating.** Asking how they feel first and only sending the link to the happy ones. Common in the trades, sold as a feature by several tools, still against policy.
 - 3. Asking for a specific star rating.** "If we earned five stars..." biases the review. Ask for a review; do not name the number.
 - 4. Review stations, kiosks and shared tablets on site.** Handing a customer your iPad to leave a review on the spot is no longer acceptable practice, and it produces a cluster of reviews from one device and one location, which is exactly the footprint automated systems look for. A card the homeowner takes away and scans later on their own phone is the supported route.
 - 5. Buying reviews.** They arrive in a recognisable burst from unrelated accounts and put the whole profile at risk. This includes the cheap "50 reviews for \$99" services and it includes reciprocal review-swap groups, which are a conflict of interest under the same policy.
 - 6. Reviews from staff, family, and your own accounts.** Also a conflict of interest. It is also obvious — reviewers with one review, no photo, posted the same week.
 - 7. Offering to fix a bad review for money, or paying to have one removed.** Paying a reviewer to change or delete a review falls under the same incentivized-content rule as paying for one in the first place.
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Things people think are against the rules but are not

- **Asking every single customer.** Encouraged. Google's own help pages tell you to remind customers with a link or QR code.
 - **Asking more than once.** One follow-up is fine. It is a judgement call about being annoying, not a policy question.
 - **Putting the link on invoices, emails, business cards, door hangers, yard signs and your website.** All fine.
 - **Replying to negative reviews, including firmly.** Fine, as long as you are not abusive and do not publish the customer's private information.
 - **Flagging reviews you believe break the rules.** That is the documented process. Use it.
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If it happens anyway

If reviews disappear or the profile gets restricted:

1. **Stop whatever generated them,** immediately, before anything else.
2. **Do not start a second profile.** Duplicate profiles for one location make the original problem much harder to fix.
3. **Use the appeal process** from inside your Google Business Profile.
4. **Expect it to take weeks,** and expect the first appeal to be refused if you cannot point to what changed.

The professionals who do reinstatement work charge somewhere between \$150 and \$800 a listing, most of them only on success. That is a fair measure of both how hard this is to undo and how much cheaper it is not to trip it in the first place.

Printing your review cards

What you need first

Your Google review QR code. Get it from your **Google Business Profile** → **"Ask for reviews"** — Google makes both the link and the QR code for you, free.

Use Google's own QR code rather than a third-party generator. Free generators often route through their own domain so they can charge you later or show ads, and if that company disappears every card you printed stops working.

Making the cards

1. Open **06-print-cards.html** by double-clicking it. It opens in your browser. It works offline and nothing is uploaded anywhere — the file never leaves your computer.
2. Type in your company name and phone number.
3. Change the headline and sub-line if you want. The defaults are fine.
4. Click **Choose File** and pick your QR code image.
5. Press **Print sheet**. Four cards per page.

Print settings: plain paper is fine, card stock is better if the crew is handing them over in the weather. Print at 100% — do not let the printer shrink to fit, or the QR code can get too small to scan reliably.

Test one before you print a hundred

Print one sheet, then **scan the code with a phone that is not yours**. You want to confirm two things: it opens the review box for the right business, and it does that on a phone that is not already signed into your Google account.

This is worth the two minutes. A box of cards with a QR pointing at the wrong location, or at a profile you no longer manage, is a season of missed reviews you never find out about.

How many to print

A stack of twenty-five per truck, topped up monthly. They cost almost nothing and the whole system fails when the truck runs out and nobody says anything.

Keeping it current

Reprint if you change your phone number or company name. **The QR code itself does not need reprinting** unless you create a new Google Business Profile — the link stays the same as your review count grows.